

Summary of all Phonetic symbols

Vowel sounds

/ə/ /ʊ/ /ɛ/ /ɑ/ /ʌ/ /oʊ/ /ʊ/ /ɔ/ /i/ /ɪ/ /æ/ /eɪ/

Diphthongs

/aɪ/ /aʊ/ /ɔɪ/

R- colored vowels

ɜ̄ ɝ Monophthongs

ɪr ɛr ər ɔr Diphthongs

aɪr Triphthong

Terminology

Vowel: a Speech Sound made with the vocal tract open.

*Vocal sound that has no obstructions (Linguistic)

Diphthong: A Sound formed by the combination of two Vowels in one Syllables.

* A vowel Sound that starts near the articulatory position for one vowel and moves toward the position for another.

R-colored vowels: A vowel followed by “r” in the same Syllable.

Syllables: Segment of speech uttered with a single impulse of air.

Consonant sounds

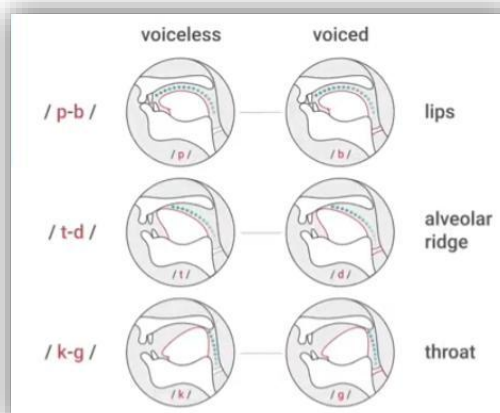
/θ/ /ð/ /r/ /m/ /b/ /k/ /g/ * /t̬/ /ŋ/ /p/ /f/

/v/ /l/ /s/ /z/ * /ʒ/ /ʃ/ /ʒ/ /n/ /h/ /tʃ/ /dʒ/

/w/ /j/ * /t̬/ /t/ /d/

Stop sound overview

A consonant sound is a speech sound in which the air stream is at least partially blocked.

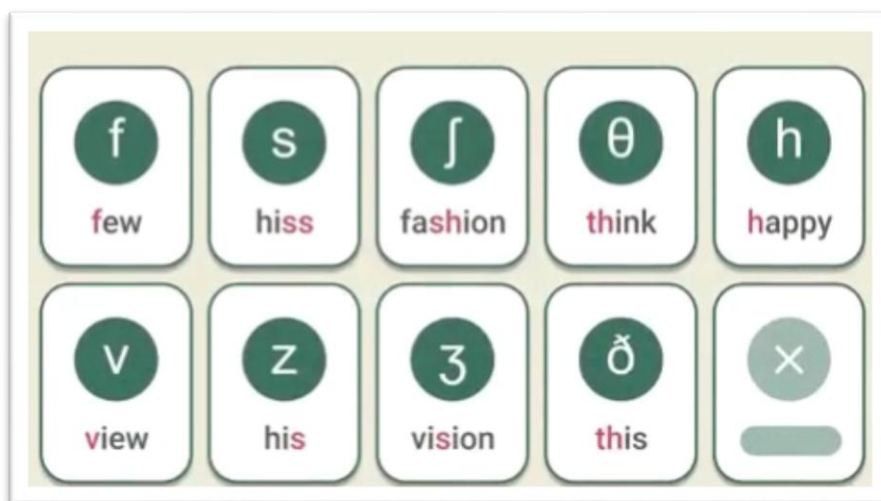


Recap:

- There are 6 stop sound in American English: /p, b, t, d, k, g/
- Voiced stops: /b, d, g/ Voiceless stops: /p, t, k/
- Make the initial stops with a puff of air (Aspirated): “play”
- Make the final stops without a puff of air (Unaspirated): “lap”
- Vowel length rule
 - Make the vowels before the voiced stops sound longer
 - Make the vowels before the Voiceless stop sound shorter
- Make a “flap /ɾ/” between voiced sounds: “water”
- Make a “glottal /ʔ/” before unstressed or weak syllables ending with /n/
- It’s okay to drop /t/ and /d/ after the /n/: “Winter” /wɪnə/

Fricative consonant sound

A sound that’s made by partially blocking the air which creates an audible friction.



Remember:

- Lightly bite your lower lip
- Make a strong continuous sound

Classification of American English sounds

*Nota: All vowel and diphthong are voiced and some consonants!

Voiceless consonants

/p/ /t/ /k/ /tʃ/ /f/ /θ/ /s/ /ʃ/ /h/

Voiced consonants

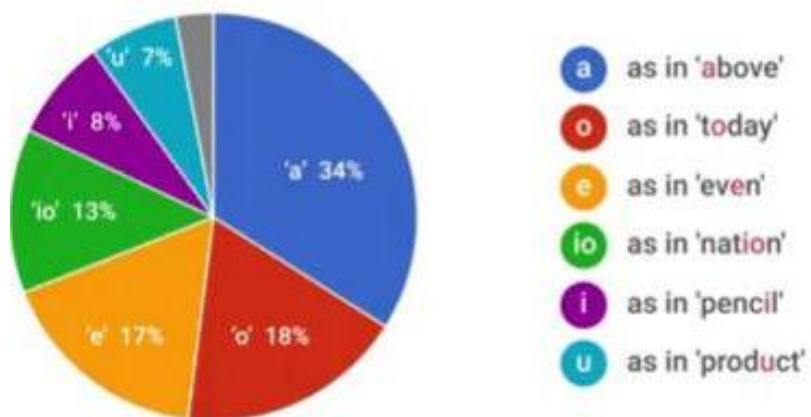
/b/ /d/ /g/ /dʒ/ /v/ /ð/ /z/ /ʒ/ /m/ /n/ /ŋ/ /l/ /w/ /j/ /r/

1) Vowel Sound ə (schwa) as in ago

The /ə/ sound is a weak version of the /ʌ/. As it's used in unstressed syllables, make it more relaxed.

Top 3 Vowel Sounds In American English

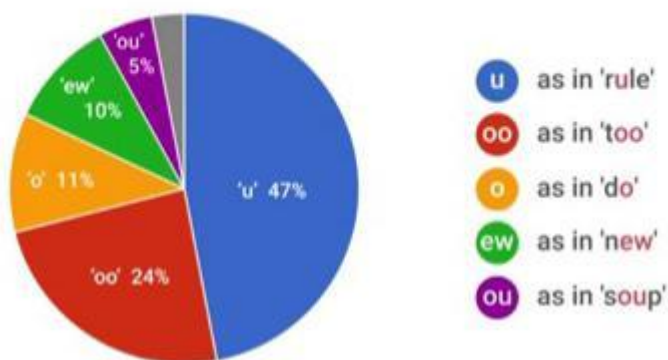
Vowel Sound / ə / Most Common Spelling



2) Sound vowel u as in “blue”

To make the /u/ sound, round your lips in a tight circle and push them forward.

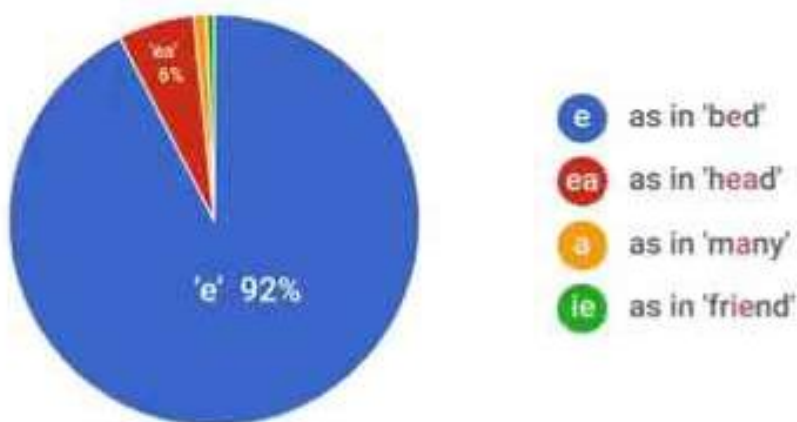
Vowel Sound / u / Most Common Spelling



3) Vowel Sound ε as in bed.

To produce the ε sound, relax your lips, relax your tongue and lower your tongue to the middle of your mouth.

Vowel Sound / ε / Most Common Spelling



4) Vowel Sound /a/ as in “got”

To pronounce the /a/ sound, flatten your tongue and drop your jaw as low as you can.

Vowel Sound /a/ Is Often Confused



Vowel Sound /a/ Most Common Spelling



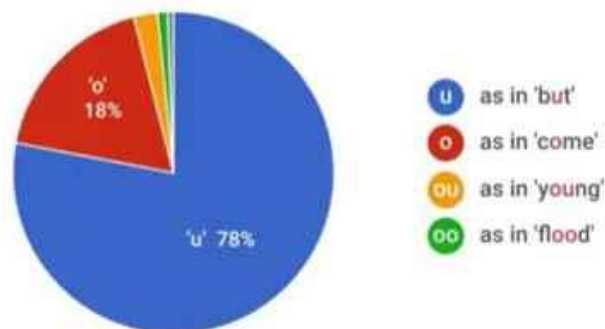
5) Vowel sound /ʌ/ as in “us”

To make the /ʌ/ sound, open your mouth slightly and relax your lips.

Vowel Sound /ʌ/ In Other Languages



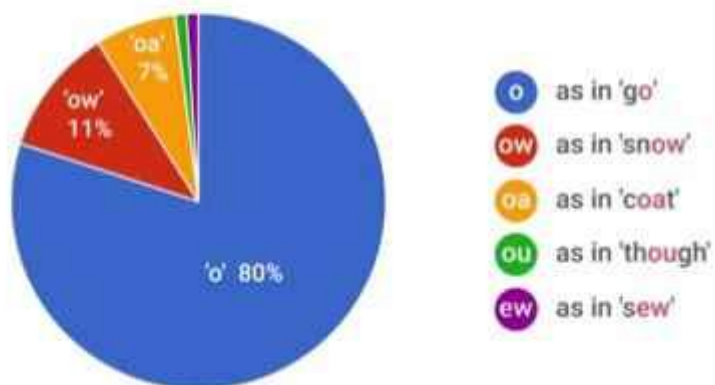
Vowel Sound /ʌ/ Most Common Spelling



6) Vowel sound /oo/ as in “go”

To say the / oo/ sound, tense your lips, round them and then pull them in a tighter circle.

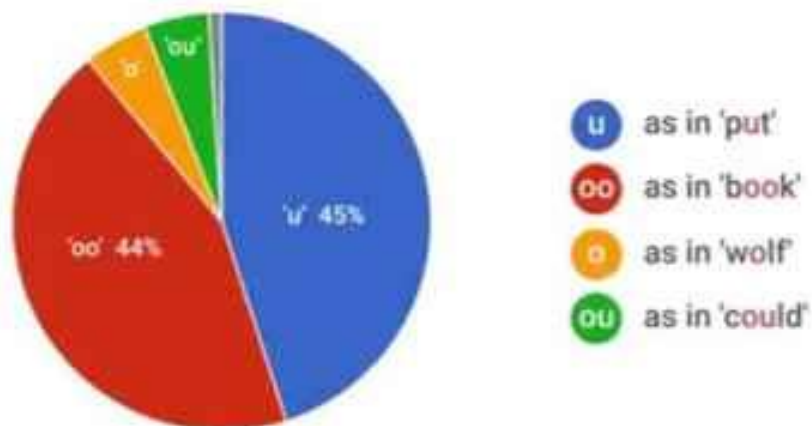
Vowel Sound / oo / Most Common Spelling



7) Vowel Sound /u/ as in put

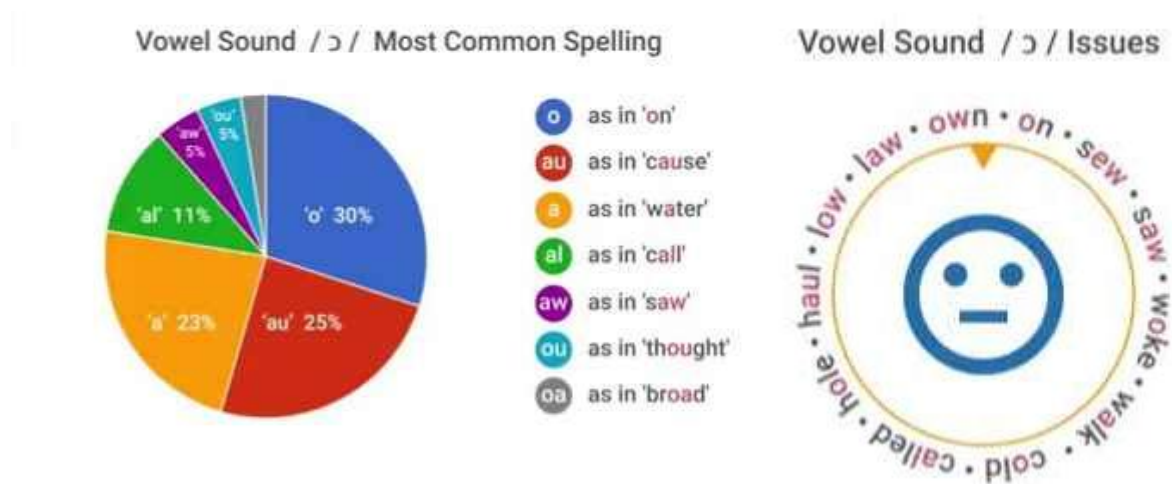
To pronounce the /u/ sound, relax your rounded lips and open your mouth slightly.

Vowel Sound / u / Most Common Spelling



8) Vowel sound /ɔ/ as in “on”

To make /ɔ/ sound, lower your tongue and open your mouth fully



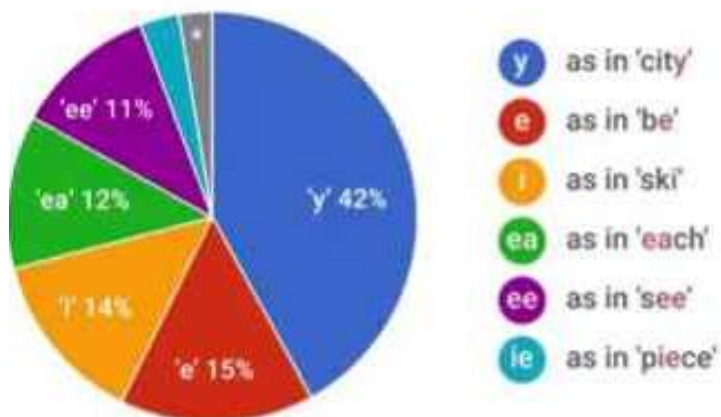
9) Vowel /i/ as in “be”

To make the /i/ sound, slightly open your mouth slightly and raise your tongue very high.

Top 3 Vowel Sounds in American English

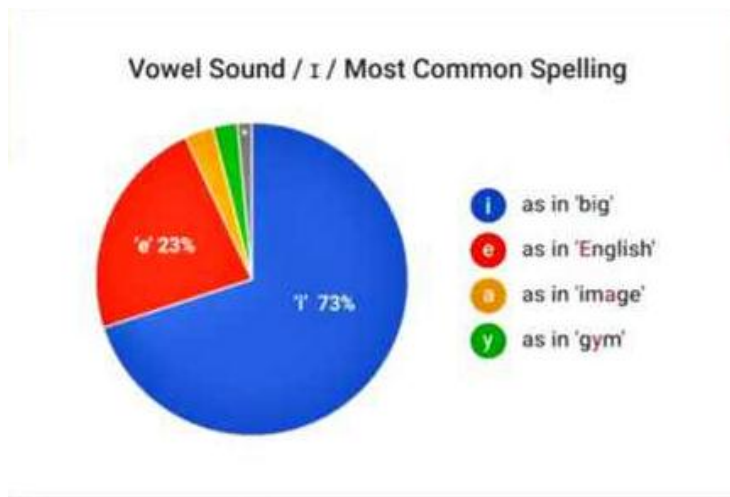
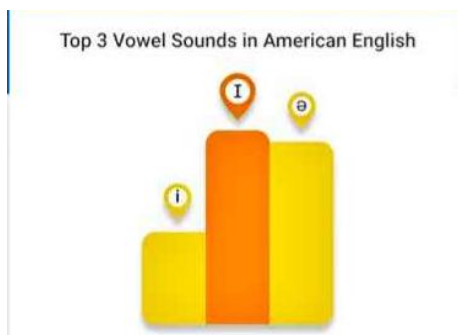


Vowel Sound /i/ Most Common Spelling



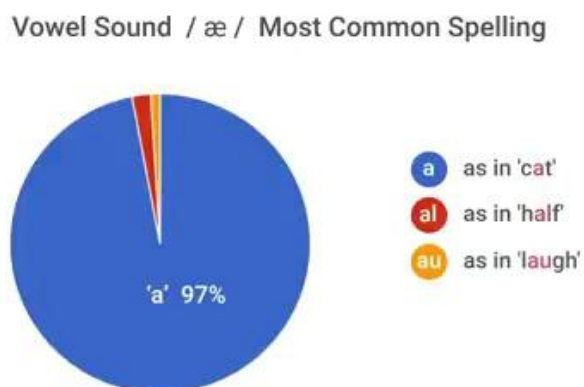
10) Vowel sound /ɪ/ as in “it”

To pronounce the /ɪ/ sound, relax your lips and raise your tongue high in your mouth.



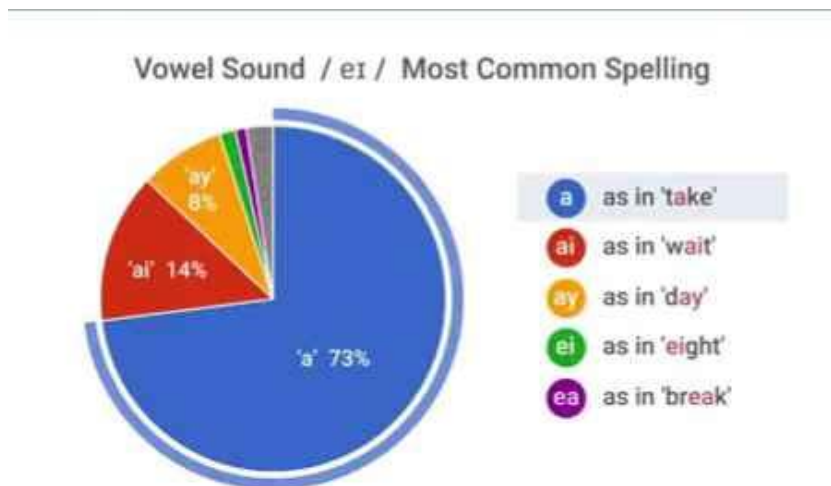
11) Vowel sound /æ/ as in cat

To pronounce the /æ/ sound, drop your jaw as low as you can and flatten your tongue.



12) Vowel sound /eɪ/ as in “make”

To make the /eɪ/ sound, tense your tongue and lips and open your mouth partially.



1) Diphthong sound /aɪ/ as in “sky”

The Diphthong sound /aɪ/ is formed by blending two vowel sounds in one Syllable, as in “like” and “sky”.

 Diphthong /ˈdɪp-θɔŋ/
- a sound formed by the combination of two vowels in one syllable

Remember

 Do not reduce the second sound in diphthongs!

2) *Diphthong sound /aʊ/ as in “cloud”*

The Diphthong sound /aʊ/ is formed by blending two vowel sounds in one Syllable.

Remember:

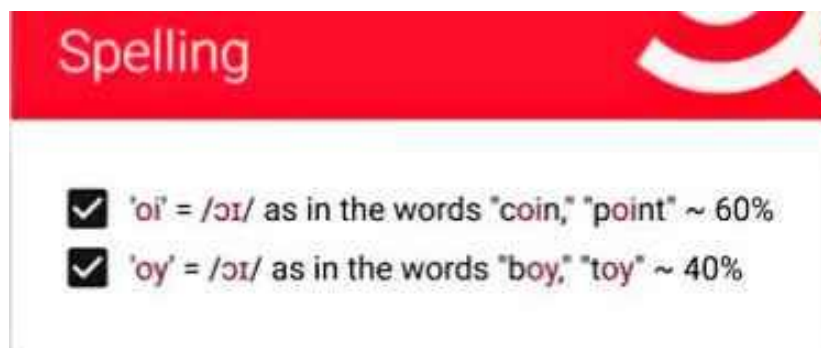
- Do not reduce the second sound in Diphthongs
- Do not pronounce Diphthongs through the nose



3) *Diphthong sound /ɔɪ/ as in “Boy”*

The Diphthong sound /ɔɪ/ is formed by blending two Vowel sounds in one Syllable.

*Do not reduce the second sound in diphthong!



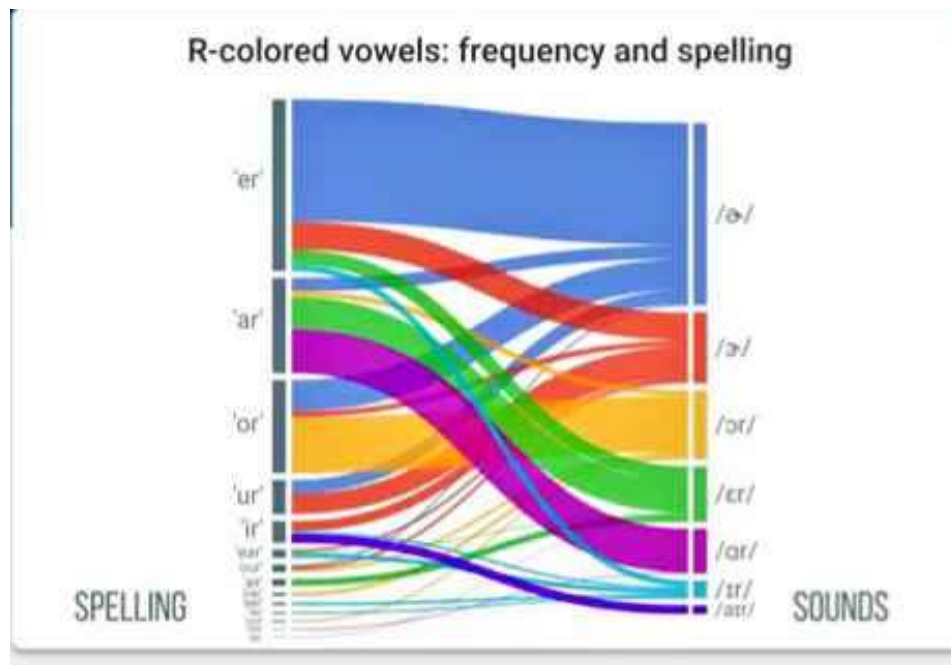
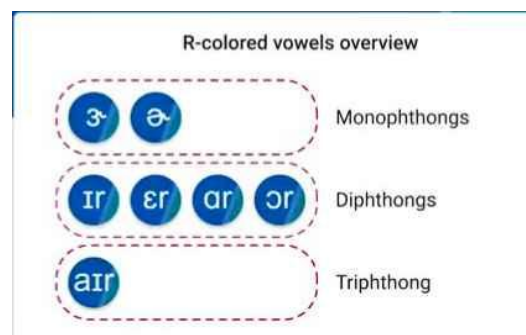
R- Colored Vowel Sound Overview

R-colored vowel: A vowel followed by “r” in the same Syllable

Recap:

- ✓ A vowel followed by 'r' in one syllable is an R-colored vowel.
- ✓ ~ 24% of American English words have an R-colored vowel.
- ✓ Most non-native speakers mispronounce R-colored vowels.
- ✓ The /ɜ/ and the /ə/ are the R-colored monophthongs.
- ✓ The /ɪr/, /ɛr/, /ər/, and /ɔr/ are the R-colored diphthongs.
- ✓ The /aɪr/ is the R-colored triphthong.

🔗 find links to the R-colored vowels videos in the description below



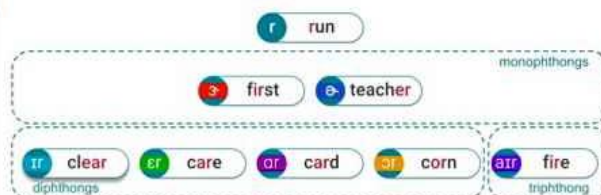
1) R-colored vowel sound /ɜ:/ as in “first”

Make the /ɜ:/ sound your mouth a little open and your lips slightly rounded. Tense your tongue and curl its tip back.

R-Colored Vowel Sound /ɜ:/

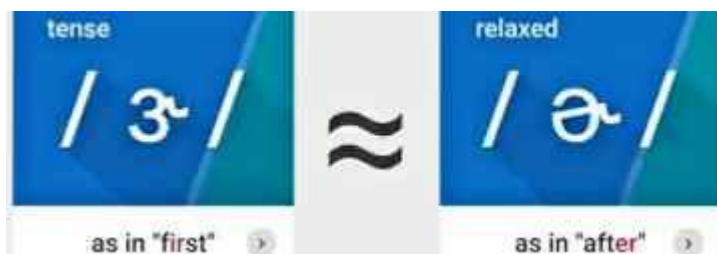
- ✓ vowel + 'r' = R-colored vowel sound
- ✓ /ɜ:/ occurs in stressed syllables
- ✓ /ə/ is a weak version of /ɜ:/
- ✓ /ə/ occurs in unstressed syllables

R-Colored Vowel Sound /ɜ:/



2) R-colored vowel sound /ə/ as in “after”

The /ə/ sound is a weak version of the /ɜ:/. To make it, open your mouth slightly, relax your lips, and curl the tip of your tongue back.



... previously on Sounds American

- ✓ vowel + 'r' = R-colored vowel sound
- ✓ /ɜ:/ can be spelled with different vowel letters
- ✓ /ɜ:/ occurs in stressed syllables

R-Colored Vowel Sound /ə/



words with the /ə/ sound that are often mispronounced

R-Colored Vowel Sound /ə/



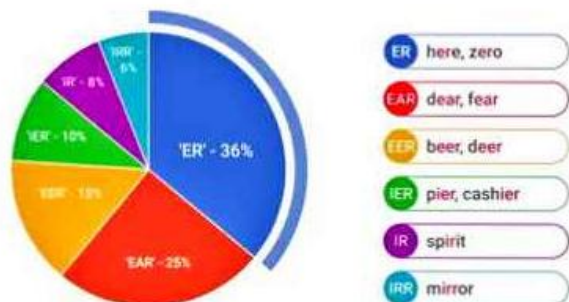
1) R- Colored Vowel Sound /ɪr/ as in “hero”

- ✓ It's okay to make a sound in between tense /i/ and relaxed /ɪ/
- ✓ Some dictionaries this sound as /ɪər/, /ɪ/ or /ɪr/

Remember:

- Do not reduce the /r/ sound.
- Avoid trilling the /r/ sound in R-colored vowel.

R-colored vowel sound /ɪr/ – most common spelling



R-colored vowels overview recap:

- ✓ The /ɪr/ is one of the seven American R-colored vowels.
- ✓ The /ɪr/ is an R-colored diphthong.
- ✓ The /ɪr/ is made by merging the /ɪ/ and the /r/ sounds.
- ✓ Most non-native speakers mispronounce R-colored vowels.
- ✓ The spelling for /ɪr/ could be confusing.

🔗 find the link to the R-colored vowels overview in the description below

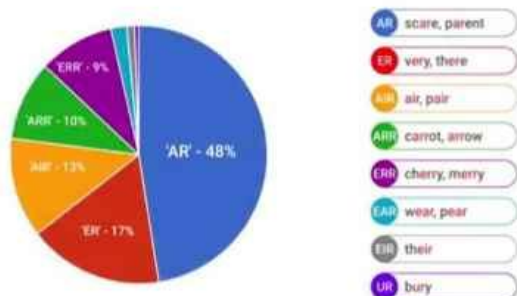
2) R-colored vowel sound /ɛr/ as in “chair.”

Start with the /ɛ/ sound then link it with the /r/, curling the tip of your tongue back.

Remember:

- Do not reduce the /r/ sound in R-colored vowel.
- Avoid trilling the /r/ sound in R-colored vowel.

R-colored vowel sound /ɛr/ – most common spelling



R-colored vowels overview recap:

- ✓ The /ɛr/ is one of the seven American R-colored vowels.
- ✓ The /ɛr/ is an R-colored diphthong.
- ✓ The /ɛr/ is made by merging the /ɛ/ and the /r/ sounds.
- ✓ Most non-native speakers mispronounce R-colored vowels.
- ✓ The spelling for /ɛr/ could be confusing.

🔗 find the link to the R-colored vowels overview in the description below

3) R-colored vowel sound /ar/ as in “car”

Start with /a/ and then link it with the /r/, curling the tip of your tongue back.

Remember:

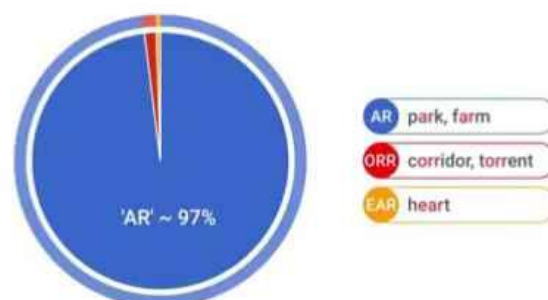
- Do not reduce the /r/ sound in R-colored vowel.
- Avoid trilling the /r/ sound in R-colored vowel.

R-colored vowels overview recap:

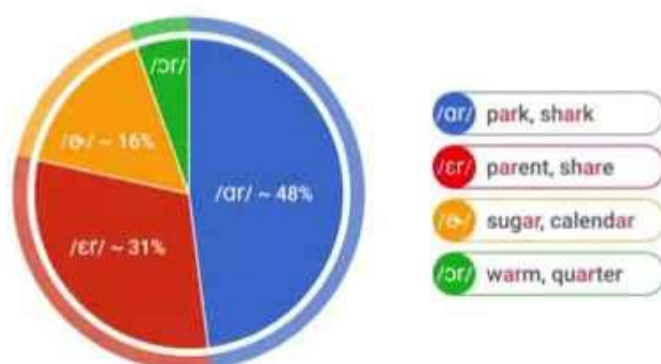
- ✓ The /ar/ is one of the seven American R-colored vowels.
- ✓ The /ar/ is an R-colored diphthong.
- ✓ The /ar/ is made by merging the /a/ and the /r/ sounds.
- ✓ Most non-native speakers mispronounce R-colored vowels.
- ✓ The spelling for /ar/ could be confusing.

🔗 find the link to the R-colored vowels overview in the description below

R-colored vowel sound /ar/ – most common spelling



Beware! 'AR' can be pronounced 4 different ways!



4) R-colored vowel sound /ɔr/ as in “sport”

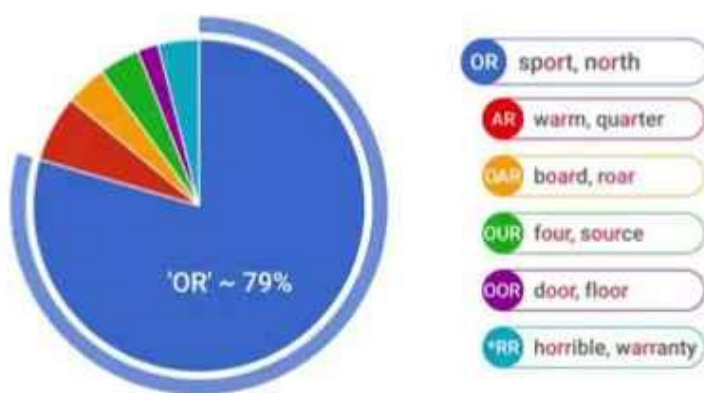
Start with the /ɔ/ sound then link it with /r/, curling the tip of your tongue back.

*Some dictionaries represent this sound as /or/, /ɔɪ/, /oɪ/, /ɔə/ !

Remember:

- Do not reduce the /r/ sound in R-colored vowel.
- Avoid trilling the /r/ sound in R-colored vowel.

R-colored vowel sound /ɔr/ – most common spelling



R-colored vowels overview recap:

- ✓ The /ɔr/ is one of the seven American R-colored vowels.
- ✓ The /ɔr/ is an R-colored diphthong.
- ✓ The /ɔr/ is made by merging the /ɔ/ and the /r/ sounds.
- ✓ Most non-native speakers mispronounce R-colored vowels.
- ✓ The spelling for /ɔr/ could be confusing.

[🔗](#) find the link to the R-colored vowels overview in the description below

1) R-colored vowel sound /aɪr/ as in “fire”

Start with the Diphthong /aɪ/ then link it with the /r/, curling the tip of your tongue back.

*Some dictionaries represent this sound as /aɪər/ or /aɪə̯/!

Remember:

- Do not reduce the /r/ sound in R-colored vowel.
- Avoid trilling the /r/ sound in R-colored vowel.

R-colored vowels overview recap:

- ✓ The /aɪr/ is one of the seven American R-colored vowels.
- ✓ The /aɪr/ is an R-colored triphthong.
- ✓ The /aɪr/ is made by merging the /aɪ/ and the /r/ sounds.
- ✓ Most non-native speakers mispronounce R-colored vowels.
- ✓ The spelling for R-colored vowels could be confusing.

🔗 find the link to the R-colored vowels overview in the description below

R-colored vowel sound /aɪr/ – most common spelling



R-colored vowel sound /aɪr/ – most common spelling



Consonant sounds

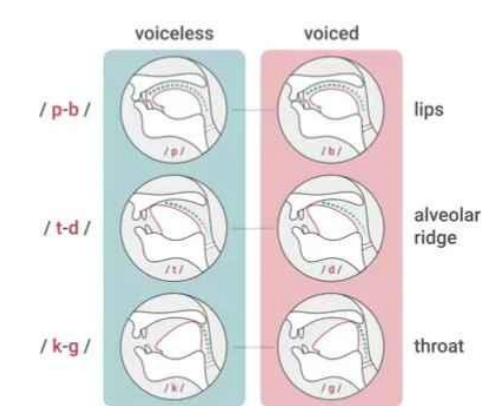
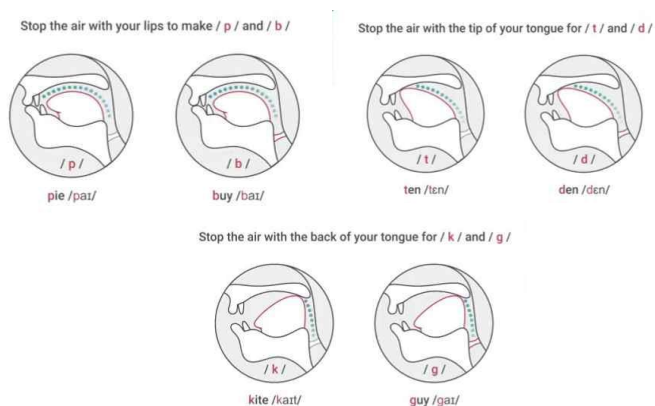
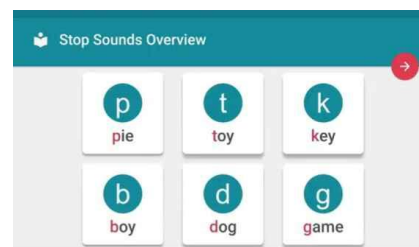
Stop sound overview American English Pronunciation.

Consonant sounds: A consonant sound is a speech sound in which the air stream is at least partially blocked.

Stop sounds: 80% of English words have at least one stop sound!

Stop sounds:

- First, the air stream is stopped in your mouth
- Next, it's released with a puff of air



Aspiration: making a sound with a puff of air

Final stop rule: At the end of words (and syllables) stop sounds are made without a puff of air.

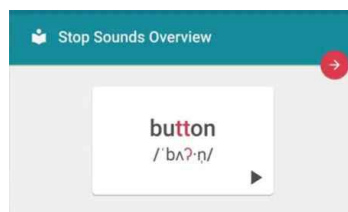
Terminology:

- Aspirated: stop sounds with a puff of air
- Unaspirated: stop sounds without a puff of air

Vowel Length Rule: There's something else you'll need to know about vowels before consonant sounds.

Vowel Length Rule: Vowels before Voiceless stop sounds are shorter than Vowels before voiced stops.

Positional Variations: There are two more ways to pronounce the /t/ sound in American English.



Recap: conversational tempo

- ✓ There are 6 stop sounds in American English: / p,b,t,d,k,g /
- ✓ Voiced stops: / b,d,g /; voiceless stops: / p,t,k /
- ✓ Make the initial stops with a puff of air: "pay" /peɪ/
- ✓ Make the final stops without a puff of air: "lap" /ləp/
- ✓ Make the vowels before the voiced stops longer
- ✓ Make a "flap T" between voiced sounds: "water" /'wɔ:t̚ə/
- ✓ Make a "glottal T" in words like "button" or "certain"
- ✓ It's okay to drop /t/ and /d/ after the /n/: "winter" /'wɪn̚ə/

American Stop Sounds Quiz

- ✓ city flap T
- ✓ eight unaspirated stop
- ✓ kitten glottal T
- ✓ bet aspirated stop
- ✓ bid longer vowel
- ✓ bit shorter vowel

Can you recall the rules that apply to these words?

1) *TH* consonant sound /θ/ as in “think”

Place the tip of your tongue between your teeth and release air over your tongue to make the /θ/ sound.



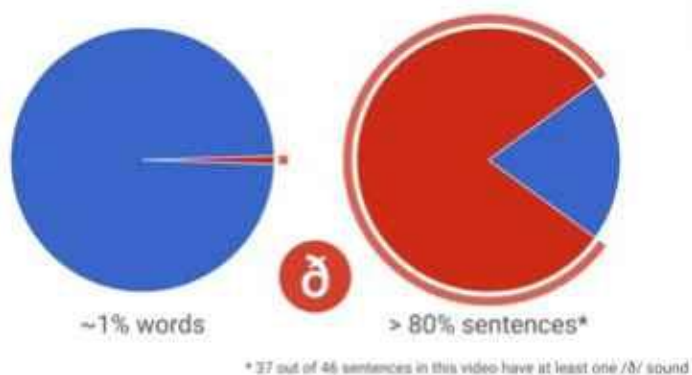
'TH': Voiceless / θ / vs. Voiced / ð /

θ think	ð there
θ theater	ð this
θ health	ð that
θ birthday	ð bathe
θ breath	ð breathe

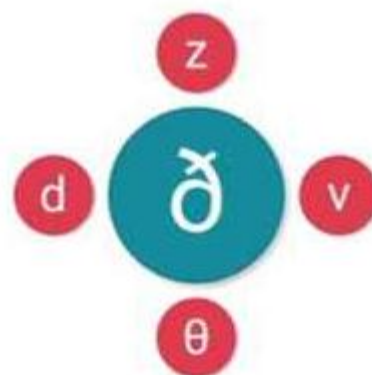
2) *TH* consonant sound /ð/ as in “this”

Place the tip of your tongue between your teeth and release air over your tongue adding your voice.

Consonant Sound / ð / Frequency of Use



Consonant Sound / ð / Typical Issues

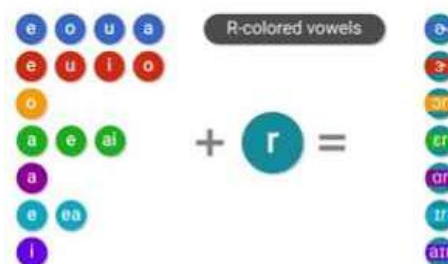


3) Consonant sound /r/ as in “run”

To pronounce the /r/ sound, curl the tip of your tongue back. Avoid touching your tooth ridge.



Consonant Sound /r/ and R-Colored Vowels



4) Consonant sound /m/ as in “map”

To pronounce the /m/ sound, close your lips and direct the air to your nose.



Good news!

95% of languages have the /m/ sound



News that's not so good

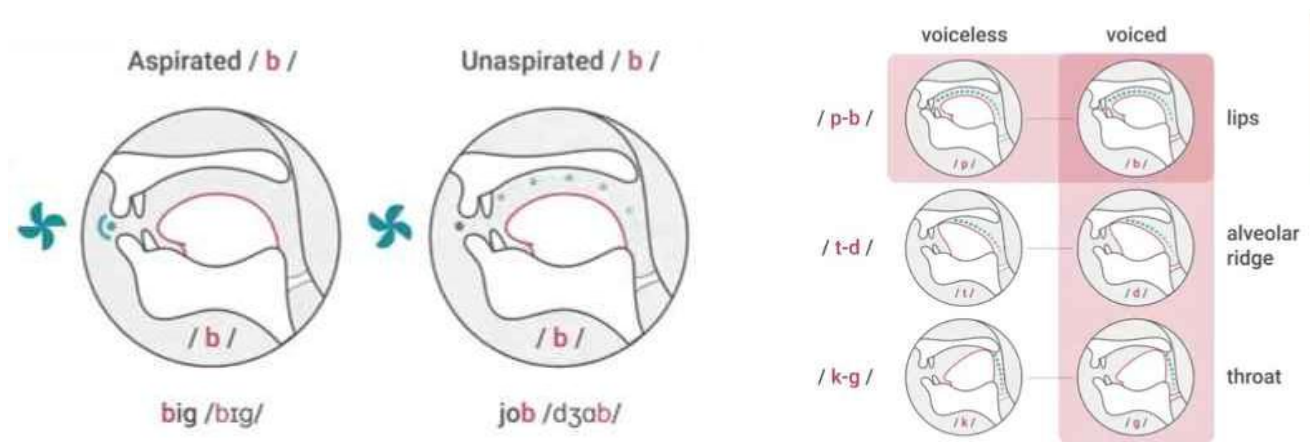
Pronunciation of the /m/ sound may vary

Consonant Sound /m/ Practice - Part 3

/m/ vs. /n/ vs. /ŋ/
do not confuse your nasals!

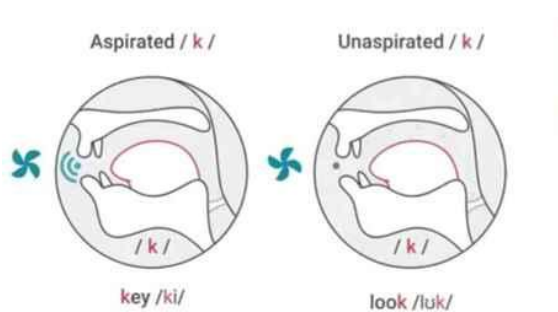
5) Consonant sound /b/ as in “boy”

The /b/ is made with a slight puff of air at the beginning of words and unstressed syllables.

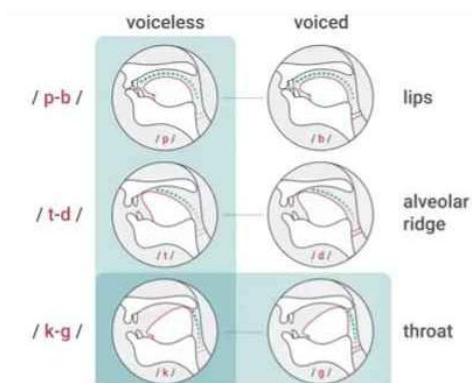


6) Consonant sound /k/ as in “key”

The /k/ is made with a strong puff of air at the beginning of words and stressed syllables.



/k/ is not aspirated after /s/

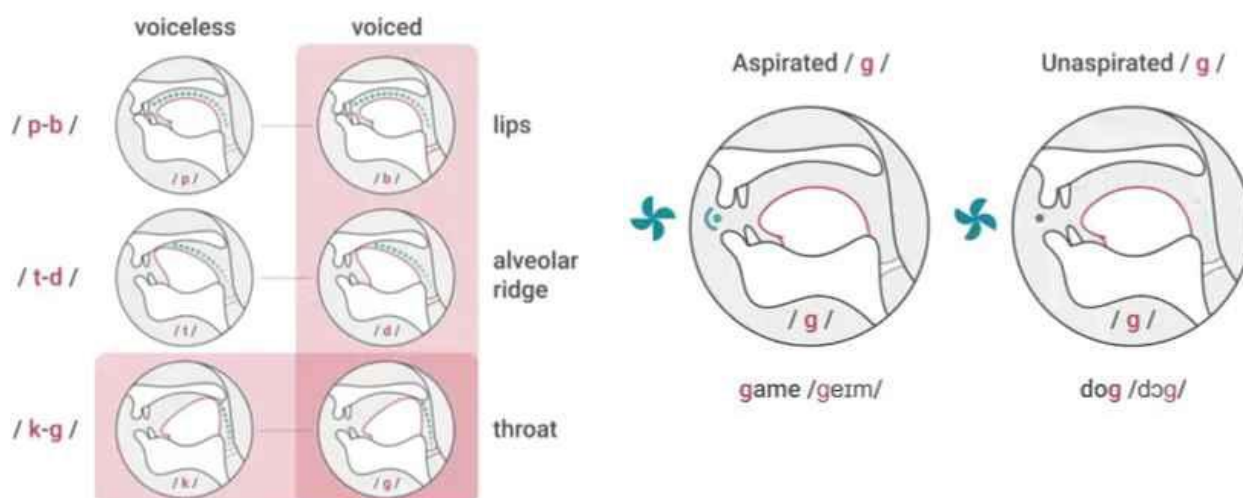


Consonant sound /k/ most common spelling



7) Consonant sound /g/ as in “gift”

The /g/ is made with a slight puff of air at the beginning of words and stressed syllables.



Beware of spelling !

Do not confuse the /g/ and the /dʒ/ sounds!



Pronounce letter 'G' as /dʒ/ before 'E, I, Y'*



Pronounce letter 'G' as /g/ before consonants*



*note exceptions like 'get,' 'give,' 'girl.'

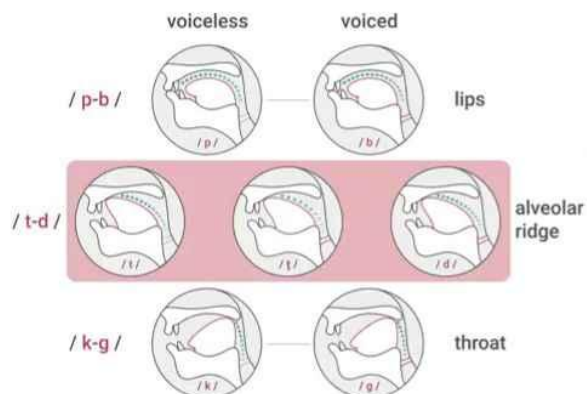
8) Consonant sound flap T */t/ as in “water”

The /t/ sound becomes a flap t /ɾ/ when it's surrounded by voiced sounds. It's made by voicing the /t/ consonant and sounds like a quick /d/.

Disclaimer:

- It's okay to always use a regular “T”
- The flap */t/, however, sounds more American.

water
/'wɒt̬ə/



9) Consonant sound /ŋ/ (ng) as in “thing”

To make the /ŋ/ sound, pull the back of your tongue up to the throat and force the air to your nose.



Hold on tight, we'll explain it in a minute!



Hold on tight, we'll explain it in a minute!



Hold on tight, we'll explain it in a minute!

The consonant sound /ŋ/ cheat sheet:

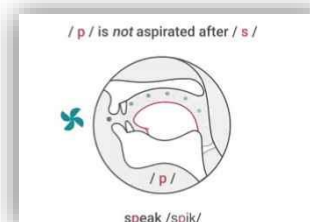
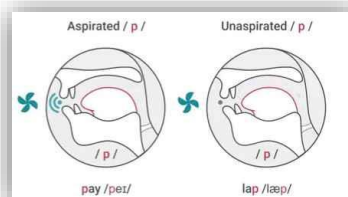
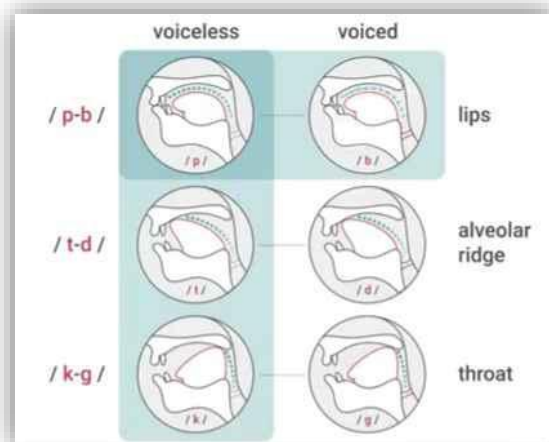
- ✓ "••ng" → / ••ŋ / at the end of a word
- ✓ "•ng•" → / •ŋg• / in the middle of a word
- ✓ "•nk•" = "•nc•" → / •ŋk• / wherever it occurs

10) Consonant sound /p/ as in “pie”

The /p/ is made with a strong puff of air at the beginning of words and stressed syllables.

Remember, stop sounds at the end of words are made without a puff of air.

Remember, the /p/ sound is made without a puff of air in the /sp/ cluster.

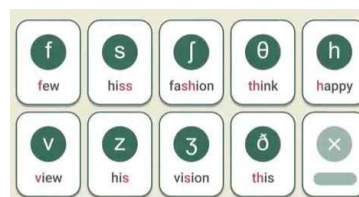


11) Consonant sound /f/ as in “fun”

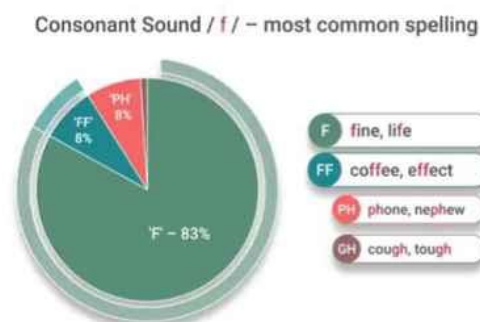
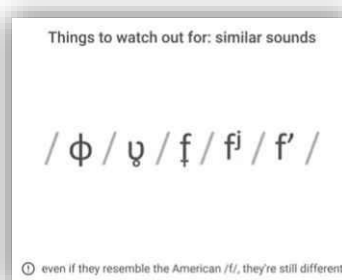
- Lightly bite your lower lip and release a stream of air over it to make the /f/ sound.
- Make sure you gently bite your lower lip (in middle).
- Make a vowel before the /f/ shorter (final).

Remember:

- Lightly bite your lower lip
- Make a strong continuous sound



Fricative consonant: A that's made by partially blocking the air which creates an audible friction



12) Consonant sound /v/ as in “very”

- Lightly bite your lower lip and release a stream of air over it to make the /v/ sound, don't forget to add your voice.
- Make sure you gently bite your lower lip (middle)
- Make vowels before the /v/ longer (final)



Fricative consonant: A that's made by partially blocking the air which creates an audible friction.

Remember:

- Lightly bite your lower lip
- Make a strong continuous sound
- Add your voice

Did you know? The /v/ sound is always represented by the letter “v”. But there's one exception. There is, “of” **Λv**

13) Consonant sound /l/ as in “Let”

To make the /l/ sound, put the tip of your tongue at your tooth ridge and release air over the sides of your tongue.



14) Consonant sound /s/ as in “Sun”

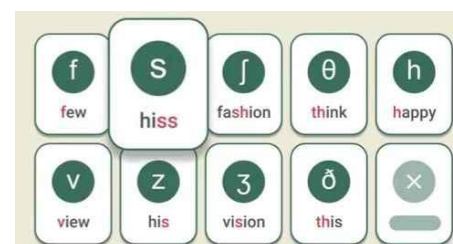
Raise the tip of your tongue towards your tooth ridge and release air over your tongue to make the /s/ sound.

Don't touch your alveolar ridge with the tip of your tongue (middle), (ask)

Make vowels before the /s/ sound shorter (final), (advice)

Fricative consonant: A that's made by partially blocking the air which creates an audible friction.

*More than 5% of English words begin with the /s/ + consonant combination: **Spanish**



15) Consonant sound /z/ as in “zoo”

Raise the tip of your tongue towards your tooth ridge and release air over your tongue to make the /z/ sound. Don't forget add your voice.

*Make a voiced sound with a longer vowel before it. “Cousin” /kʌz'ən/

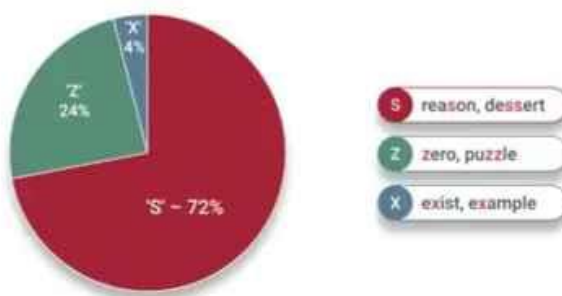
Fricative consonant: A that's made by partially blocking the air which creates an audible friction.



f few	s hiss	ʃ fashion	θ think	h happy
v view	z his	ʒ vision	ð this	x —



Consonant Sound /z/ – most common spelling



16) Consonant sound glottal T */ʔ/ as in “Button”

The regular /t/ sound becomes a glottal */ʔ/ sound before unstressed syllables containing /n/:
“Latin kitten in satin mittens”.

Disclaimer:

- ✓ It's okay not a mistake to use a regular “T”.
- ✓ The glottal “T”, however, sounds more American.

Glottal “T” Step 1

Link the “regular” /t/ sound and the /n/ consonant without a vowel in between .

Glottal “T” step 2

Practice making a glottal stop using the common American expression “uh-oh”

Glottal “T” step3

Replace the /t/ sound with the glottal “T” in the word “button” /bʌʔ'n/

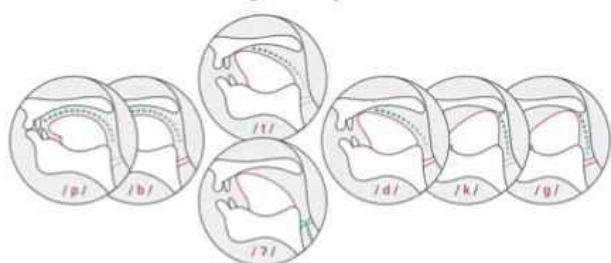
Is it worth learning?

(-) Glottal ‘T’ occurs in just about 0.5% of words

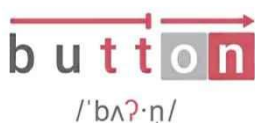
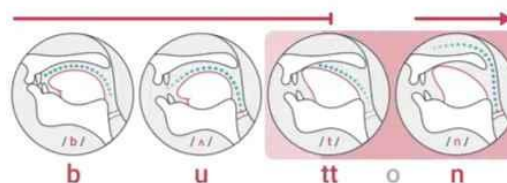
(+) But it'll make you sound “more American”



Six American English stop consonant sounds



Why does a “regular” /t/ become a glottal 'T'?



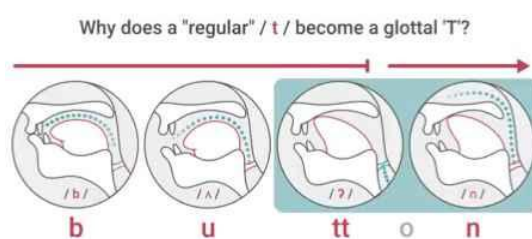
17) Consonant sound /ʃ/ as in “show”

Practice words with the sound /ʃ/ represented by the combination of letters “sh” [1].

Let's practice words where this sound is represented by the letters “ch” and the letter “c”.

[2] (chef) /ʃɛf/.

Now let's practice pronouncing words in which the /ʃ/ sound is represented by the letter “t”

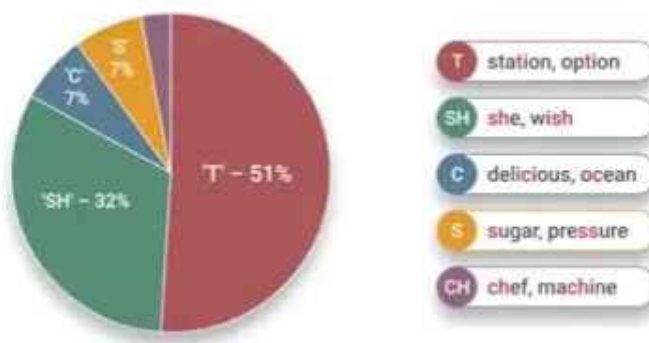


[3] (Election) /əˈlɛkʃən/.

Fricative consonant: A that's made by partially blocking the air which creates an audible friction.



Consonant Sound /ʃ/ – most common spelling



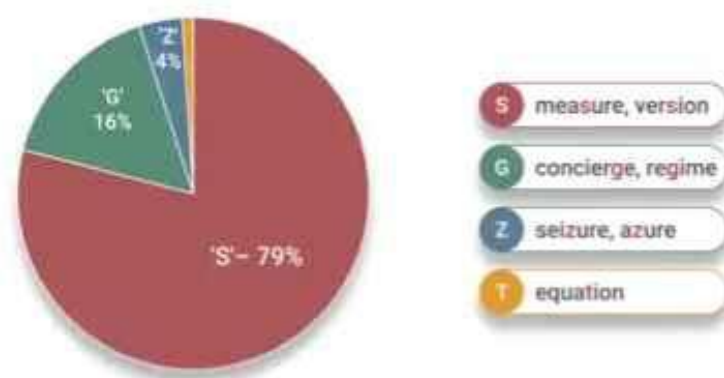
18) Consonant sound /z/ as in “Vision”

Arch your tongue towards the roof of your mouth and release a noisy airstream to make the /z/ sound, don't forget to add your voice.

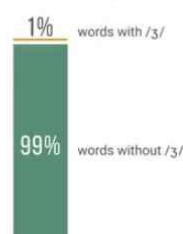
Fricative consonant: A that's made by partially blocking the air which creates an audible friction.



Consonant Sound /z/ – most common spelling



Consonant Sound /z/



19) Consonant sound /n/ as in “nice”

- To make the /n/ sound, put the tip of your tongue at your tooth ridge and direct the air to your nose: “Nine men Ned a plan”.
- /n/ x 2: “Nine”
- 80% language have the sound /n/

Consonant Sound /n/

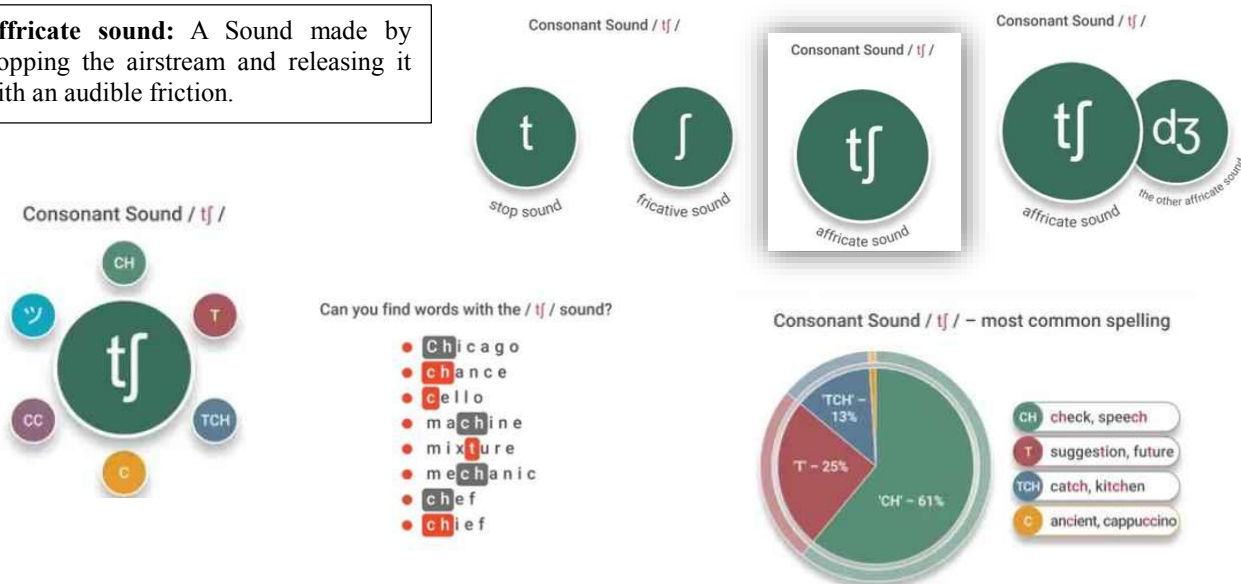


The most frequent consonant in American English

21) Consonant sound /tʃ/ as in “chair”

- Practice words with the sound /tʃ/ represented by the combination of letters “ch” or “tch” [1]. (Chance) /tʃæs/.
- Let’s practice words where this sound is represented by the “t” [2]. (Question) /'kwɛs'tʃən/
- Now let’s practice words in which the letters “ch” are not pronounced as the /tʃ/ sound. (Ache) /eɪk/

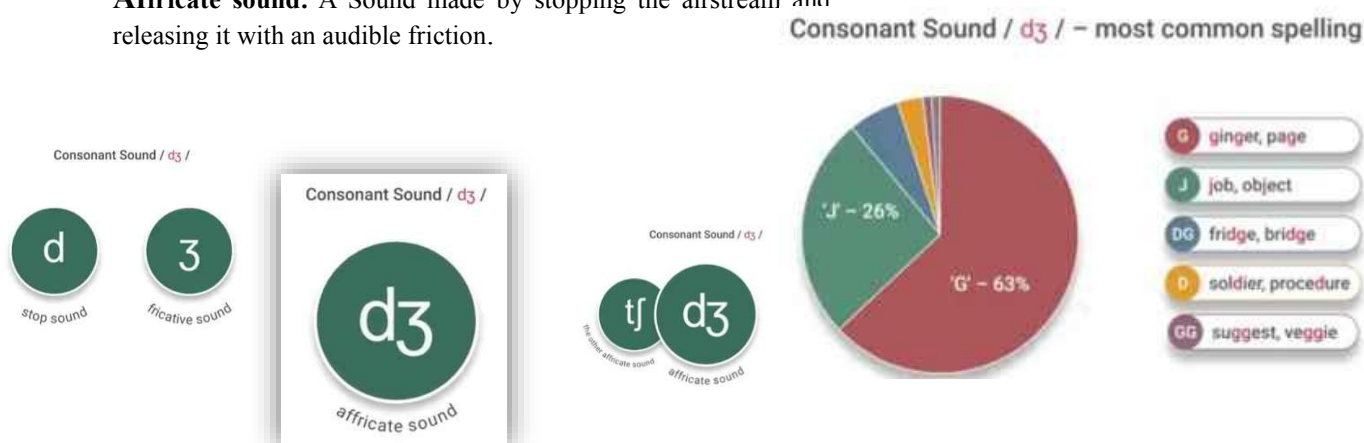
Affricate sound: A Sound made by stopping the airstream and releasing it with an audible friction.



22) Consonant sound /dʒ/ as in “job”

- The /dʒ/ sound at the beginning of words [1] (gel) /dʒel/
- Make sure to stop the air and then release it with friction [2] (Adjust) /ə'dʒʌst/
- Make a voiced sound with a longer vowel before it. [3] (Average) /'æv.rɪdʒ/

Affricate sound: A Sound made by stopping the airstream and releasing it with an audible friction.

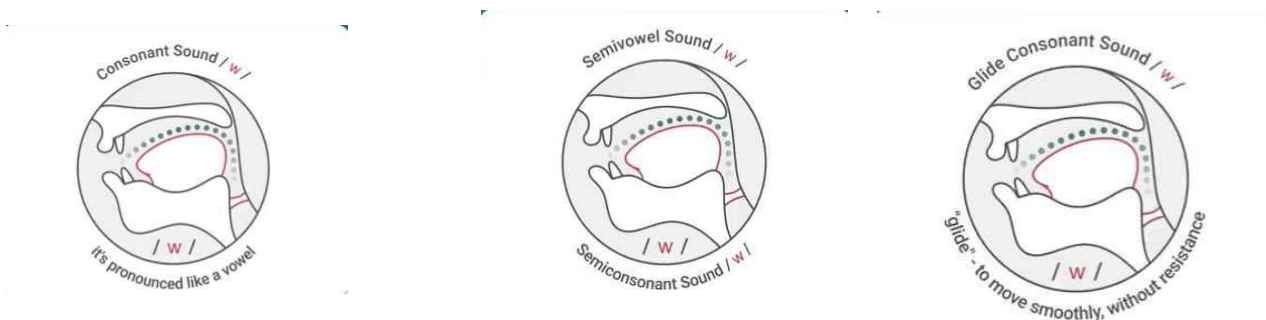


23) Consonant sound /w/ as in “way”

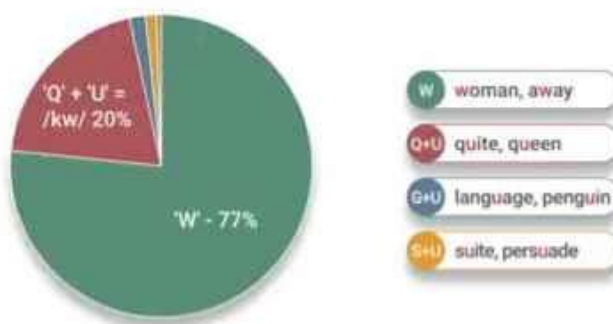
Consonant sound: A consonant sound is a speech sound in which the air stream is at least partially blocked.

Glide sound: A glide is a sound that is made with the air flowing over the tongue when it leaves the mouth.

- Practice words with the sound /w/ represented by the letter ‘w’. [1] (Work) /wɜ:k/.
- Let’s practice words where this sound is represented by the letter ‘u’ in ‘-qu-’ or ‘-gu-’ combination. [2] (Frequent) /'frik.wənt/
- Let’s practice words where the /w/ sound is Not pronounced. [3] (answer) /'æn.sə/



Consonant Sound /w/ – most common spelling

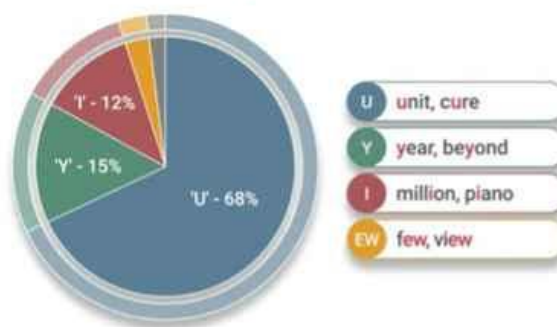


24) Consonant sound /j/ as in “yes”

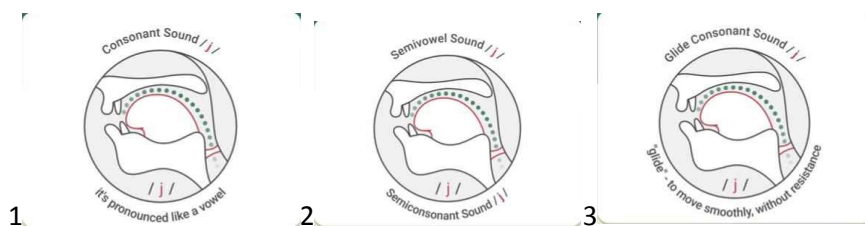
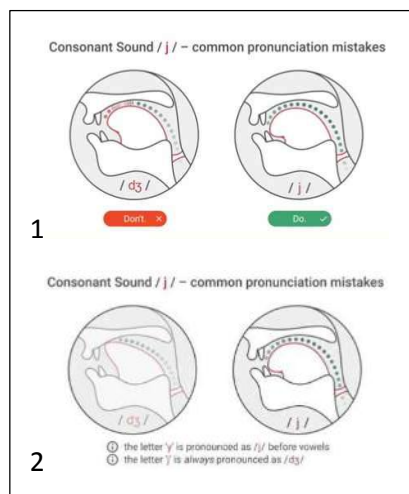
- Practice words with the sound /j/ represented by the letter ‘y’ [1]. (Young) /jʌŋ/
- Let’s practice words in which the /j/ sound is represented by the letters ‘u’ and ‘i’. [2]
(Value) /væl.ju/, (Opinion) /ə'pɪn.jən/.

Glide sound: A glide is a sound that is made with the air flowing over the tongue when it leaves the mouth.

Consonant Sound /j/ – most common spelling



*The /j/ always occurs before vowel sounds, but it’s not part of a vowel.



25) **Consonant sound Dark L /ɫ/ as in call, American English Pronunciation.**

Dark L: The “dark” L is only a positional variation of the /l/ sound and not a distinct consonant!



- Practice words with the /l/ sound after the back vowel sounds [ɪ]. (Bold) /boʊɫd/
- Let's practice Words in which the /l/ sound occurs after the central and front vowel sounds. [ɪ]. (Salad) /'sæl.əd/
- Now you'll have to guess which /l/ sound to pronounce: the 'regular' or the 'dark' one? [ɪ]. (Place) /pleɪs/.

When should you and shouldn't you make the "dark" L?

1 **tool** /tuɫ/ **full** /fʊɫ/ **gold** /ɡoʊɫd/ **fault** /fɔʊɫt/

When should you and shouldn't you make the "dark" L?

2 **deal** /diɫ/ **mail** /meɪɫ/ **tell** /tɛɫ/ **final** /faɪnəl/

When should you and shouldn't you make the "dark" L?

3 **play** /pleɪ/ **clean** /kliːn/ **light** /laɪt/ **look** /lʊk/

When should you and shouldn't you make the "dark" L?

1 **beware of** /biːwəɪv/ **a.k.a. "soft" L**

Consonant Sound /l/ – common pronunciation mistakes

2 **/l/** (distorted /l/ sound) **/ɫ/** as in "tool," "full"

Bottom line:

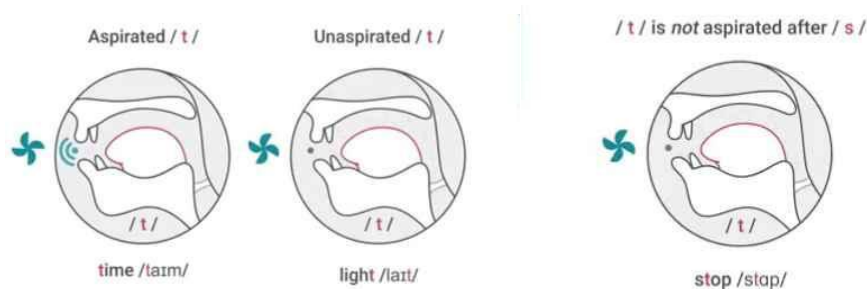
- It's okay to always pronounce the “regular” /l/
- Avoid using the “soft” /l/ sound!

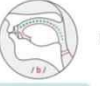
Did you know? The /l/ consonant slightly affects the Pronunciation of the preceding vowel sounds.

Vowels before the /l/: Vowel sounds before the /l/ are pronounced slightly further back and higher in your mouth.

26) Consonant sound /t/ as in “toy”, American English Pronunciation.

- The /t/ is made with a strong puff of air at the beginning of words and stressed syllables.[1] (Tea) /'ti/. Aspirated/t/.
- Remember, stop sounds at the end of words are made without a puff of air.[2]. (Airport) /'er.pɔrt/. Unaspirated t.
- Remember, the /t/ sound is made without a puff of air in the /st/ cluster.[3]. (Stable) /'steɪ.bəl/. Cluster.



	voiceless	voiced	
/p-b/			lips
/t-d/			alveolar ridge
/k-g/			throat



27) Consonant sound /d/ as in “dog”, American English Pronunciation.

- The /d/ is made with a slight puff of air at the beginning of words and stressed syllables.[1]
(Daily) /'deɪ.li/. Aspirated /d/.
- Remember, stop sounds at the end of words are made without a puff of air. [2]. (Add) /æd/.
Unaspirated /d/.
- Pronounce words with more than one /d/ which one is aspirated and which one is not? [3].
(Dad) /dæd/.

The diagram is divided into two sections. The top section, labeled 'Aspirated /d/', shows three words: 'day' (/deɪ/), 'a·ddress' (/əˈdres/), and 'do' (/du/). Each word is in a box with a play button icon. Below these boxes, a note states: '① in these words the /d/ is made with a slight puff of air'. The bottom section, labeled 'Unaspirated /d/', shows three words: 'bed' (/bed/), 'grade' (/ɡreɪd/), and 'road' (/roʊd/). Each word is in a box with a play button icon. Below these boxes, a note states: '① in these words the /d/ is made without a puff of air'.

